

SRI VAISHNAVA DOSSIER: BATCH 6

(POST-RAMANUJA & PRECEPTORS)

BATCH EXECUTIVE SUMMARY TABLE

Personality Name	Tamil Month / Nakshatram	Avathara Sthalam (Birthplace)	Divine Amsam	Primary Literary / Philosophical Contribution
Ananthazhwaran	Chithirai / Chithirai	Sirudhavaoor (near Chengalpattu)	Ananta / Adishesha (Divine Serpent aspect)	<i>Godha Chatusshloki</i> ; Established Tirumala <i>Nandavanam</i> (flower garden kinkaryam) by order of Sri Ramanuja.
Vaduga Nambi	Chithirai / Aswini	Salagramam (Karnataka)	Madhurakavi Azhwar aspect	<i>Yathiraja Vaibhavam</i> ; Formulated absolute <i>Acharya Abhimana Nishta</i> (exclusive devotion to Sri Ramanuja alone).
Nanjiyyar	Panguni / Uttaradam	Thirukaramban oor (Uttamar Kovil)	Madhava Amsam	<i>9000 Padi Vyakhyanam</i> on <i>Tiruvaymoli</i> ; Authored commentaries on <i>Tiruvaymoli</i> , <i>Kanninun Siruthambu</i> ,

				and <i>Sharanagati Gadya</i> .
Nampillai	Karthigai / Krithigai	Nambur (near Tiruchirappalli)	Lokacharya Amsam	Oral discourses compiled into the monumental <i>Eedu 36000 Padi</i> ; Transformed Srirangam into the intellectual capital of Dravida Vedanta.
Periyavachan Pillai	Aani / Rohini	Senganaloor (near Kumbakonam)	Abhaya Hasta (Divine Hand of Protection aspect)	<i>Naalayira Divya Prabandha Vyakhyanam</i> ; Honored as <i>Vyakhyana Chakravarthi</i> (Emperor of Commentators) for commenting on all 4,000 Pasurams.
Vadaku Thiruveedhi Pillai	Aani / Swathi	Srirangam	Srisailesa Amsam	Chronicled and compiled Nampillai's lectures into the <i>Eedu 36000 Padi</i> ; Authored <i>Yathindra Pravana Prabhavam</i> .

1. ANANTHAZHWAN

(Ananthacharyar, Ananthasuri, Tirumala Nandavanam Piran, Sri Venkateswara Matrubhoota)

Section 1: Identification & Incarnation Details

- **Full Name & Titles:** Ananthazhwan, Sri Ananthacharya, Ananthasuri, Tirumala Nandavanam Piran, Sri Venkateswara Matrubhoota.
- **Incarnation Metadata:**
 - **Tamil Month (Maasam):** Chithirai (Chaitra)
 - **Birth Star (Nakshatram):** Chithirai
 - **Tithi & Paksham:** 11th–12th Century CE; Sukla Paksha.
- **Geographic Origins:**
 - **Historic Birthplace Name:** Sirudhavoora (near Chengalpattu / Kanchipuram)
 - **Current District & State:** Kanchipuram District, Tamil Nadu, India.
 - **Associated Divya Desam / Temple:** Sri Venkateswara Swamy Temple (Tirumala / Thiruvengadam) and Sriperumbudur.
- **Divine Lineage & Era:**
 - **Divine Amsam:** Ananta / Adishesha (Divine Serpent Bed aspect of Sriman Narayana).
 - **Historical Period:** 11th–12th Century CE.
 - **Sovereign & Scholarly Contemporaries:** Sri Ramanuja (His Acharya), Koorathazhwan, Mudaliyandan, Parasara Bhattar.

Section 2: Complete Life History & Miracles

2.1 Chronological Life Timeline

- **Birth & Discipleship under Ramanuja:** Born at Sirudhavoora and traveling to Srirangam to become a leading disciple of Sri Ramanuja → **Accepting the Tirumala Mandate:** Voluntarily stepping forward when Ramanuja asked who would go to Tirumala to establish a flower garden (*Nandavanam*) for Lord Venkateswara → **Creating the Garden & Tank:** Digging a lake (*Ananthasaras*) and planting a garden on Tirumala hill with his pregnant wife → **The Crowbar Miracle:** Lord Venkateswara taking the form of a young boy to help his tired wife, Ananthazhwan striking the boy with a crowbar, and the Lord's chin bleeding inside the sanctum → **The Snake Bite Incident:** Refusing treatment after being bitten by a cobra, demonstrating absolute dependence on Lord Venkateswara → **Authoring Godha Chatusshloki:** Composing four verses praising Andal's grace → **Ascension:** Merging into the holy Tamarind tree precinct at Tirumala.

2.2 Deep Biographical Narrative

- **Early Years & Spiritual Awakening:** Born into an orthodox Vedic family in Sirudhavoora, Ananthazhwan moved to Srirangam to surrender at the feet of Sri Ramanuja. He was renowned for his unwavering obedience to his Acharya's word and his physical stamina in *Kainkaryam*.
- **Core Seva / Kainkaryam:** *Nandavana Kainkaryam* (Establishing and maintaining the flower garden at Tirumala) and *Pushpa-Kainkaryam* (weaving daily garlands for Lord Venkateswara).

- **Miracles & Historical Events:**

1. *The Tirumala Garden Assignment:* During a discourse on Nammalwar's *Tiruvaymoli*, Sri Ramanuja reached the verse *Sindhoo Poomagizhum Thiruvengadatthu*, which expresses the desire to offer fresh flowers to Lord Venkateswara. Ramanuja asked his assembly: "Who among you will go to Tirumala to dig a tank and plant a garden for the Lord?" While others hesitated due to the dense forests and wild animals on Tirumala hill, Ananthazhwan stood up instantly, declaring: "I shall obey my Acharya's command!"
 2. *The Crowbar and the Bleeding Chin:* While digging a pond for the garden, Ananthazhwan worked relentlessly alongside his pregnant wife. Pitying her exhaustion, Lord Venkateswara assumed the form of a young Brahmin boy and began assisting her by carrying baskets of earth. When Ananthazhwan noticed the boy helping, he grew angry that an outsider was intruding upon their exclusive *Kainkaryam* to his Acharya. He chased the boy and threw a crowbar at him, striking him on the chin. The boy ran into the temple sanctum. When Ananthazhwan entered the temple later that evening, he was stunned to see blood trickling from the chin of the *Moolavar* idol of Lord Venkateswara. Realizing the boy was the Lord Himself, Ananthazhwan wept and applied camphor to the wound. To this day, camphor (*Paccai Karpooram*) is applied to Lord Venkateswara's chin, and the original crowbar hangs at the entrance of the Tirumala temple.
 3. *The Snake Bite Test:* While working in the garden, Ananthazhwan was bitten by a venomous cobra. When fellow devotees urged him to seek a physician or recite a protective mantra, he refused, saying: "If the snake that bit me is stronger, I will bathe in the holy Koneri tank and reach Sri Vaikuntham. If the snake of my Acharya's grace is stronger, I will stay here and continue my garden service." He simply bathed in the Swami Pushkarini tank and returned to work completely unharmed.
- **Guru-Disciple Dynamics:** Prime disciple of Sri Ramanuja; pioneer of the Tirumala Vaishnava community.
 - **Attainment of Paramapadam:** Passed away at Tirumala, transforming into a sacred Magizha tree near the temple precinct.



Sthala Puranam & Legend Highlight: The Crowbar at Tirumala Entrance

The iron crowbar used by Ananthazhwan hangs on the outer wall of the main entrance (*Mahadwaram*) of the Tirumala temple. It stands as an enduring physical monument to an Acharya's absolute dedication to physical *Kainkaryam*.

Section 3: Literary, Preservation & Philosophical Contributions

- **Complete List of Works:**
 - *Godha Chatusshloki* (4 Sanskrit verses glorifying Sri Andal).
 - *Venkatachala Itihasa Mala* (Chronicle documenting Sri Ramanuja's reforms and activities at Tirumala).
- **Quantified Output:** 4 Sanskrit verses (*Godha Chatusshloki*) and 1 historical text.
- **Associated Divya Desams (Mangalasasanam):** Tirumala (Thiruvengadam), Sriperumbudur, Srirangam.
- **Sampradaya Defense & Preservation:** Established the continuous Sri Vaishnava liturgical and garden tradition at Tirumala. He defended Sri Ramanuja's administrative

procedures on the holy hill against local opposition.

- **Predominant Bhakti Bhava & Philosophical Core: Acharya-Aagya-Palanam**
(Unquestioning obedience to the Acharya's word) and **Kainkarya-Nishta**.

Section 4: Representative Verses & Theological Breakdown

Verse 1: Godha Chatusshloki, Verse 1 (*Sri Vishnu Chitta Kula Nandanakalpa Vallim*)

Text Layer	Content
Original Script (<i>Sanskrit</i>)	ஸ்ரீவிஷ்ணுசித்தகுலநந்தனகல்பவல்லீம் ஸ்ரீரங்கராஜஹரிசந்தனயோகத்ருஸ்யாம் । ஸாக்ஷாத் க்ஷமாம் கருணயாகமலாமிவாந்யாம் கோதாமனந்யஸரணஃ ஸரணம்ப்ரபத்யே ॥
Roman Transliteration	<i>Sri Vishnu Chitta kula nandana kalpa vallim</i> <i>Sri Ranganaraja harichandana yoga drushyam</i> <i>Sakshat kshamam karunaya Kamalam ivanyam</i> <i>Godham ananya sharanah sharanam prapadye</i>
Literal Word-by-Word Meaning	Sri Vishnu Chitta: Of Periyalwar (Vishnuchitta); Kula: dynasty/family; Nandana: delighting; Kalpa vallim: the wish-fulfilling divine creeper; Sri Ranganaraja: of Lord Ranganatha; Harichandana: the sacred sandal tree; Yoga drushyam: beautiful when united with; Sakshat kshamam: patience/Mother Earth personified; Karunaya: by compassion; Kamalam iva anyam: like a second Goddess Lakshmi; Godham: unto Goddess Andal; Ananya sharanah: having no other

	refuge; Sharanam prapadye : I take absolute surrender!
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Exhaustive Theological & Philosophical Commentary:

1. **Esoteric Meaning (Swaroopā Jnanam):** Ananthazhwan offers prostration to Goddess Andal (Godha), describing her as a celestial wish-fulfilling vine (*Kalpa Valli*) originating in the garden of Periyalwar. She winds gracefully around the sandal-wood tree of Lord Ranganatha (*Sri Ranganatha*), embodying the patience of Mother Earth (*Bhu Devi*) and the boundless mercy of Goddess Lakshmi (*Kamala*).
2. **Viśiṣṭādvaita Alignment:** Establishes **Purushakara-Tattva** (Mediation of the Divine Mother). In Viśiṣṭādvaita, Andal is approached not only as an Azhwar, but as an incarnation of Bhu Devi who intercedes on behalf of bound souls (*Samsarins*).
3. **Commentarial Insights:** Sri Vedanta Desika praised *Godha Chatusshloki* as the primary inspiration for his own *Godha Stuti*, noting that Ananthazhwan captured the essence of Andal's dual role as devotee and divine Queen in just four verses.

Section 5: Visuals & Archival Resources

5.1 Iconography & Shrine Visual Description

- **Physical Posture (Asana):** Standing in a posture of physical labor holding a crowbar (*Padarai*) and basket (*Poodai*), or seated in *Anjali Mudra*.
- **Hand Gestures (Mudras):** Hands carrying garden tools or joined in prayer (*Anjali Mudra*).
- **Garments & Embellishments:** Dressed in simple cotton vestments, marked with twelve *Urdhva Pundra* (tilak) marks, wearing *Tulasi* seed bead garlands.
- **Avathara Sthalam Idol Description:** At Tirumala and Sirudhavoora, Ananthazhwan's icon depicts him with his garden basket and crowbar, permanently dedicated to Lord Venkateswara's floral service.

5.2 Academic Audio/Video Lecture Queries

- "Ananthazhwan Tirumala History and Crowbar Miracle Velukkudi Krishnan"
- "Godha Chatusshloki Lecture Karunakarachariar"
- "Ananthazhwan Vaibhavam at Tirumala Ananthapadmanabhachariar"

5.3 Digital Text & Archival Links

- **Dravida Veda Repository:** <http://www.dravidaveda.org>
- **Project Madurai Texts:** <https://www.projectmadurai.org>
- **Koyil Archival Library:** <https://koyil.org>

2. VADUGA NAMBI

(*Andhrapurna, Salagramam Piran, Ramanuja-Ekantha-Sishya, Acharya-Abhimana-Nishta*)

Section 1: Identification & Incarnation Details

- **Full Name & Titles:** Vaduga Nambi, Andhrapurna, Salagramam Piran, Ramanuja-Ekantha-Sishya, Exemplar of Acharya-Abhimana-Nishta.

- **Incarnation Metadata:**
 - **Tamil Month (Maasam):** Chithirai (Chaitra)
 - **Birth Star (Nakshatram):** Aswini
 - **Tithi & Paksham:** 11th–12th Century CE; Sukla Paksha.
- **Geographic Origins:**
 - **Historic Birthplace Name:** Salagramam (Karnataka region)
 - **Current District & State:** Mysuru / Hassan Region, Karnataka, India.
 - **Associated Divya Desam / Temple:** Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple (Srirangam) and Salagramam Shrine.
- **Divine Lineage & Era:**
 - **Divine Amsam:** Madhurakavi Azhwar aspect (Re-manifestation of Madhurakavi's absolute Guru-devotion).
 - **Historical Period:** 11th–12th Century CE.
 - **Sovereign & Scholarly Contemporaries:** Sri Ramanuja (His absolute God and Acharya), Koorathazhwan, Mudaliyandan, Embar.

Section 2: Complete Life History & Miracles

2.1 Chronological Life Timeline

- **Birth at Salagramam:** Born in the Karnataka village of Salagramam → **Encounter with Sri Ramanuja:** Surrendering to Sri Ramanuja during Ramanuja's journey to Melkote and becoming his intimate personal attendant (*Ekantha Kainkaryaparar*) → **Absolute Devotion to the Guru:** Refusing to look at temple deities, considering Sri Ramanuja's physical form as his sole God (*Devu Matrariyen*) → **The Boiling Milk Incident:** Boldly refusing to step out to see the royal procession of Lord Ranganatha because he was boiling milk for Ramanuja → **Authoring Yathiraja Vaibhavam:** Chronicling the life and divine activities of Sri Ramanuja → **Ascension:** Entering *Paramapadam* shortly after Ramanuja's departure.

2.2 Deep Biographical Narrative

- **Early Years & Spiritual Awakening:** Born into a Kannada-speaking family in Salagramam, Vaduga Nambi met Sri Ramanuja during the master's stay in Karnataka. Captivated by Ramanuja's spiritual luster, Vaduga Nambi abandoned all worldly attachments and became Ramanuja's personal servant (*Ekantha Sishya*).
- **Core Seva / Kainkaryam:** *Antharanga Kainkaryam* (Preparing warm milk, carrying the ascetic staff, and tending to Ramanuja's physical needs).
- **Miracles & Historical Events:**
 1. *The Boiling Milk Incident:* One day, the grand annual procession (*Uthsavam*) of Lord Ranganatha was passing right outside Ramanuja's residence in Srirangam. Drums sounded and thousands cheered. Ramanuja called out to Vaduga Nambi: "Vaduga, come out and behold the divine beauty of Lord Ranganatha!" Vaduga Nambi replied from the kitchen: "If I come out to see your Ranganatha, the milk I am boiling for my Ranganatha (Ramanuja) will boil over!" This incident proved that for Vaduga Nambi, Sri Ramanuja was not just a Guru, but the Supreme Being Himself.
 2. *Refusal to Gaze upon Temple Deities:* When accompanying Ramanuja into temple

sanctums across India, Vaduga Nambi would keep his eyes fixed firmly on Sri Ramanuja's face, never turning to look at the stone or metal idols (*Moolavars*). When asked why, he quoted Madhurakavi Azhwar's verse: "*Devu Matrariyen*" ("I know no other God than my Acharya"). He stated: "*My eyes that have seen the living embodiment of grace—Ramanuja—have no desire to see anything else.*"

3. **The Holy Sandals Protection:** Vaduga Nambi carried Sri Ramanuja's sacred sandals (*Paduka*) wrapped in a clean cloth everywhere they traveled, treating them with higher reverence than temple holy water (*Theertham*).

- **Guru-Disciple Dynamics:** Personal attendant and intimate disciple to Sri Ramanuja.
- **Attainment of Paramapadam:** Unable to endure life on earth after Sri Ramanuja's departure, Vaduga Nambi passed away shortly thereafter at Srirangam.

💡 **Sthala Puranam & Legend Highlight: The Archetype of Acharya-Nishta**

Vaduga Nambi is venerated in Sri Vaishnava tradition as the post-Ramanuja re-manifestation of Madhurakavi Azhwar. He demonstrated that **Acharya-Abhimana-Nishta** (total absorption in the Acharya) is an independent, complete path to salvation.

Section 3: Literary, Preservation & Philosophical Contributions

- **Complete List of Works:**
 - *Yathiraja Vaibhavam* (Sanskrit biographical chronicle documenting the life, miracles, and daily routine of Sri Ramanuja).
 - *Ramanuja Ashtottara Shatanama Stotram* (The 108 sacred names of Sri Ramanuja).
- **Quantified Output:** 1 major historical biography and 1 liturgical hymn.
- **Associated Divya Desams (Mangalasasanam):** Salagramam, Srirangam, Melkote.
- **Sampradaya Defense & Preservation:** Preserved the authentic biographical details of Sri Ramanuja's life through eye-witness accounts. He established the liturgical practice of worshipping Sri Ramanuja in daily household rituals.
- **Predominant Bhakti Bhava & Philosophical Core: Charama-Parva-Nishta / Acharya-Devatvam** (Viewing the Acharya as the Supreme Deity).

Section 4: Representative Verses & Theological Breakdown

Verse 1: Yathiraja Vaibhavam Invocation (*Ramanujam Muni-Pattanam*)

Text Layer	Content
Original Script (<i>Sanskrit</i>)	ராமானுஜோ விஜயதே யதிராஜராஜஃ காருண்யராஸிரபிராமகுணாபிராமஃ । தத்பாதபங்கஜரஜோத்ருதஉத்தமாங்க ஃ வடுகாபிதானமுனிரேஷ பஜே ததாக்கியாம் ॥

Roman Transliteration	<i>Ramanujo vijayate yathirajarah</i> <i>Karunyarashir abhiramagunabhiramah</i> <i>Tatpadapankajarajodhruta utthamangah</i> <i>Vadukabhidhana muniresha bhaje</i> <i>tadakhyam</i>
Literal Word-by-Word Meaning	Ramanujo: Sri Ramanuja; Vijayate: stands eternally victorious; Yathirajarah: the King of Kings among ascetics; Karunyarashir: an ocean of compassion; Abhirama guna abhiramah: charming due to His delightful qualities; Tat pada pankaja rajo: the dust of His lotus feet; Dhruta utthamangah: wearing upon his head; Vadukabhidhana munir: the sage named Vaduga Nambi; Esha: this servant; Bhaje tadakhyam: worships His holy name continuously!

Exhaustive Theological & Philosophical Commentary:

1. **Esoteric Meaning (Swaroopā Jnanam):** Vaduga Nambi proclaims the eternal victory of Sri Ramanuja—the King of Ascetics and ocean of compassion. He describes himself as one whose head is permanently adorned with the sacred dust from Ramanuja's lotus feet (*Tat Pada Pankaja Rajo*), knowing no other spiritual practice than chanting Ramanuja's name.
2. **Viśiṣṭādvaita Alignment:** Establishes **Acharya-Padadhooli-Mahima** (The supreme power of the dust of the Acharya's feet). In Sri Vaishnavism, the dust of the Acharya's feet is the ultimate purifier, capable of destroying all residual *Karmic* bonds.
3. **Commentarial Insights:** Sri Manavala Mamunigal highlights that Vaduga Nambi's writings are free from poetic exaggeration because they were written by an eye-witness who lived as Ramanuja's shadow for decades.

Section 5: Visuals & Archival Resources

5.1 Iconography & Shrine Visual Description

- **Physical Posture (Asana):** Standing in *Anjali Mudra* or carrying Sri Ramanuja's ascetic staff (*Tridandam*) and sandals (*Paduka*).
- **Hand Gestures (Mudras):** Hands joined in prayer (*Anjali Mudra*) or holding a vessel of warm milk.
- **Garments & Embellishments:** Dressed in simple householder vestments, marked with

twelve *Urdhva Pundra* (tilak) marks, wearing sacred thread and *Tulasi* garlands.

- **Avathara Sthalam Idol Description:** At Salagramam and Srirangam, Vaduga Nambi's icon stands gazing directly at Sri Ramanuja's form, capturing his singular focus on his Guru.

5.2 Academic Audio/Video Lecture Queries

- "Vaduga Nambi Life History and Boiling Milk Incident Velukkudi Krishnan"
- "Yathiraja Vaibhavam Lecture Karunakarachariar"
- "Acharya Abhimana Nishta Vaduga Nambi Ananthapadmanabhachariar"

5.3 Digital Text & Archival Links

- **Dravida Veda Repository:** <http://www.dravidaveda.org>
- **Project Madurai Texts:**
<https://www.projectmadurai.org>
- **Koyil Archival Library:** <https://koyil.org>

3. NANJIYYAR

(Vedanti, Thirukolambiyar, Sri Madhava, Author of 9000 Padi)

Section 1: Identification & Incarnation Details

- **Full Name & Titles:** Nanjiyyar, Vedanti, Thirukolambiyar, Sri Madhava, Author of the 9000 Padi Vyakhyanam.
- **Incarnation Metadata:**
 - **Tamil Month (Maasam):** Panguni (Phalguna)
 - **Birth Star (Nakshatram):** Uttaradam (Uttara Ashadha)
 - **Tithi & Paksham:** Born c. 1113 CE; Sukla Paksha.
- **Geographic Origins:**
 - **Historic Birthplace Name:** Thirukarambanoor (Uttamar Kovil, near Tiruchirappalli)
 - **Current District & State:** Tiruchirappalli District, Tamil Nadu, India.
 - **Associated Divya Desam / Temple:** Uttamar Kovil (Thirukarambanoor) and Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple (Srirangam).
- **Divine Lineage & Era:**
 - **Divine Amsam:** Madhava Amsam.
 - **Historical Period:** 12th Century CE.
 - **Sovereign & Scholarly Contemporaries:** Parasara Bhattar (His Acharya who conquered him in debate), Nampillai (His primary disciple), Embar.

Section 2: Complete Life History & Miracles

2.1 Chronological Life Timeline

- **Birth & Advaitic Eminence:** Born into an affluent family at Thirukarambanoor, mastering Sanskrit Shastras, becoming a celebrated Advaita scholar named Madhavacharya (Vedanti) in Melkote → **The Scholarly Debate Challenge:** Parasara Bhattar traveling from Srirangam to Karnataka on Sri Ramanuja's command to debate Vedanti → **The Historic Conquest:** Parasara Bhattar defeating Vedanti in a multi-day Vedantic debate, demonstrating the supremacy of Viśiṣṭādvaita → **Renunciation & Sannyasa:** Vedanti surrendering his immense wealth, taking sannyasa under Parasara Bhattar, and earning

the affection of his Acharya → **The Title "Nam-Jiyyar"**: Parasara Bhattar welcoming him back to Srirangam with the words "*Nam Jiyyar*" ("Our Ascetic/Saint"), which became his permanent name → **Authoring 9000 Padi Commentary**: Writing the monumental 9000 *Padi* commentary on *Tiruvaymoli* → **Mentorship of Nampillai**: Identifying and training Nampillai to lead the Sampradaya → **Attainment of Liberation**: Ascending to *Paramapadam* at Srirangam.

2.2 Deep Biographical Narrative

- **Early Years & Spiritual Awakening**: Born in Thirukarambanoor, Madhavacharya grew up to become an exceptionally wealthy and learned Advaitic scholar based in Karnataka. He was so affluent that he fed hundreds of scholars daily in his grand mansion, earning the title *Vedanti*.
- **Core Seva / Kainkaryam**: Authoring Manipravala commentaries on the *Naalayira Divya Prabandham*; preserving the commentarial lineage (*Vyakhyanam*) of Dravida Veda; serving Parasara Bhattar.
- **Miracles & Historical Events**:
 1. *The Debate with Parasara Bhattar*: Before passing away, Sri Ramanuja instructed his young successor, Parasara Bhattar, to travel to Melkote and bring the great Advaitic scholar Vedanti into the Sri Vaishnava fold. Bhattar traveled in royal palanquin style to Vedanti's mansion. Knowing that Vedanti gave free meals to all scholars, Bhattar sat in the feeding hall and refused to eat. When Vedanti asked what he desired, Bhattar replied: "*I seek a debate gift (Vada Bhiksha)!*" For nine days, they debated complex Vedantic texts. Bhattar used the *Sri Bhashyam* and *Tiruvaymoli* to systematically refute Advaitic non-duality, proving *Viśiṣṭādvaita*. Convinced, Vedanti bowed at Bhattar's feet.
 2. *The Transformation into Nanjiyyar*: Fulfilling his debate pledge, Vedanti divided his immense wealth among his wives and relatives, took ascetic vows (*Tridanda Sannyasa*), and walked to Srirangam as a penniless monk. As he approached Srirangam, Parasara Bhattar rushed out to receive him, embrace him, and exclaim: "*Em-Jiyyaro!*" ("Is this our own saint?"). From that day, he was known across Tamilakam as **Nanjiyyar** ("Our Ascetic").
 3. *Writing the 9000 Padi*: Nanjiyyar composed a comprehensive 9,000-measure (9000 *Padi*) Manipravala commentary on Nammalwar's *Tiruvaymoli*. When the original manuscript fell into the Kaveri River and was lost, Nanjiyyar's brilliant young disciple, Nampillai, rewrote the entire commentary from memory word-for-word, delighting Nanjiyyar.
- **Guru-Disciple Dynamics**: Prime disciple of Parasara Bhattar; Acharya to Nampillai (Lokacharya).
- **Attainment of Paramapadam**: Spent his remaining decades teaching *Dravida Vedam* in Srirangam before merging into *Paramapadam*.



Sthala Puranam & Legend Highlight: The Nam-Jiyyar Title

The name *Nanjiyyar* carries deep emotional warmth. It was not a formal academic title, but an expression of maternal affection (*Vatsalya*) uttered by Parasara Bhattar when welcoming his former debate opponent into his heart.

Section 3: Literary, Preservation & Philosophical Contributions

- **Complete List of Works:**
 - 9000 Padi Vyakhyanam (Monumental Manipravala commentary on *Tiruvaymoli*).
 - *Commentary on Kanninun Siruthambu*.
 - *Commentary on Thirupalliyezhuchi*.
 - *Commentary on Sharanagati Gadya*.
- **Quantified Output:** 4 major Manipravala commentaries.
- **Associated Divya Desams (Mangalasasanam):** Thirukarambanoor, Melkote, Srirangam.
- **Sampradaya Defense & Preservation:** Expanded the scope of Tamil commentarial literature (*Manipravala*), harmonizing Sanskrit Upanishadic logic with Tamil devotional poetry. He ensured the survival of Parasara Bhattar's lineage.
- **Predominant Bhakti Bhava & Philosophical Core: Sannyasa-Nishta** coupled with **Dravida-Veda-Anubhavama** (Deep emotional absorption in Tamil Pasurams).

Section 4: Representative Verses & Theological Breakdown

Verse 1: Invocation to Nanjiyyar (*Thaniyan* composed by Nampillai)

Text Layer	Content
Original Script (<i>Sanskrit</i>)	நமோ வேதாந்தவேத்யாய கூரநாதஸுதார்த்திதே । ஸ்ரீமாதவாய ஸாந்தாய நமோஸ்து நஞ்ஜீயரே ॥
Roman Transliteration	<i>Namo Vedantavedyaya</i> <i>Kuranathasutarthithe</i> <i>Srimadhavaya shantaya namo 'stu Nanjiyare</i>
Literal Word-by-Word Meaning	Namo: Prostrations; Vedanta vedyaya: to him who has understood the ultimate goal of the Upanishads; Kuranatha suta arthithe: who was sought after and won by the son of Koorathazhwan (Parasara Bhattar); Sri Madhavaya: to Sri Madhava (Nanjiyyar); Shantaya: who is the embodiment of tranquility; Namo 'stu Nanjiyare: let prostrations be offered to Nanjiyyar!

Exhaustive Theological & Philosophical Commentary:

1. **Esoteric Meaning (Swaroopā Jñanam):** Nampillai composes this invocation verse in honor of his Acharya Nanjiyyar (Sri Madhava). He describes Nanjiyyar as a master of Vedantic wisdom who was converted by Parasara Bhattar (*Kuranatha Suta*), praising his supreme inner peace (*Shanta*) and profound scholarship.
2. **Viśiṣṭādvaita Alignment:** Demonstrates the value of **Vada-Jaya** (Philosophical debate in service of truth). Nanjiyyar's life proves that intellectual brilliance, when surrendered to an authentic Acharya, matures into serene devotional wisdom.
3. **Commentarial Insights:** Periyavachan Pillai notes that Nanjiyyar's 9000 *Padi* commentary brought unprecedented clarity to *Tiruvaymoli*, laying the structural blueprint for all subsequent commentaries.

Section 5: Visuals & Archival Resources

5.1 Iconography & Shrine Visual Description

- **Physical Posture (Asana):** Seated in *Ardha Padmasana* wearing the robes of a Tridandi Sannyasi, holding palm-leaf manuscripts.
- **Hand Gestures (Mudras):** Right hand held in *Upadesha Mudra* (teaching pose), left hand holding a manuscript scroll.
- **Garments & Embellishments:** Dressed in saffron robes, bearing the *Tridandam* (ascetic staff), marked with twelve *Urdhva Pundra* (tilak) marks and *Tulasi* garlands.
- **Avathara Sthalam Idol Description:** At Uttamar Kovil and Srirangam, Nanjiyyar's icon depicts him as a tranquil, scholarly monk absorbed in scriptural exposition.

5.2 Academic Audio/Video Lecture Queries

- "Nanjiyyar Life History and Parasara Bhattar Debate Velukkudi Krishnan"
- "Nanjiyyar 9000 Padi Commentary Lecture Karunakarachariar"
- "Nanjiyyar Vaibhavam Ananthapadmanabhachariar"

5.3 Digital Text & Archival Links

- **Dravida Veda Repository:** <http://www.dravidaveda.org>
- **Project Madurai Texts:** <https://www.projectmadurai.org>
- **Koyil Archival Library:** <https://koyil.org>

4. NAMPILLAI

(Lokacharya, Jagadguru, Nambur Varadarajar, Sovereign of Srirangam Discourses)

Section 1: Identification & Incarnation Details

- **Full Name & Titles:** Nampillai, Lokacharya, Jagadguru, Nambur Varadarajar, Thirukali Devar, Sovereign of Srirangam Discourses.
- **Incarnation Metadata:**
 - **Tamil Month (Maasam):** Karthigai (Vrischika)
 - **Birth Star (Nakshatram):** Krithigai
 - **Tithi & Paksham:** Born c. 1147 CE; Sukla Paksha.
- **Geographic Origins:**
 - **Historic Birthplace Name:** Nambur (near Tiruchirappalli)
 - **Current District & State:** Tiruchirappalli District, Tamil Nadu, India.

- **Associated Divya Desam / Temple:** Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple (Srirangam).
- **Divine Lineage & Era:**
 - **Divine Amsam:** Lokacharya Amsam.
 - **Historical Period:** 12th–13th Century CE.
 - **Sovereign & Scholarly Contemporaries:** Nanjiyyar (His Acharya), Periyavachan Pillai, Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai (His illustrious disciples), Pinpazhagiya Perumal Jiyyar.

Section 2: Complete Life History & Miracles

2.1 Chronological Life Timeline

- **Birth at Nambur:** Born as Nambur Varadarajar in Nambur village → **Moving to Srirangam:** Surrendering to Nanjiyyar and becoming his foremost student → **Rewriting the Lost Commentary:** Rewriting the entire 9000 *Padi* commentary from memory after it was lost in the river, earning Nanjiyyar's eternal gratitude → **The Title "Nam-Pillai":** Nanjiyyar lovingly calling him "*Nam Pillai*" ("Our Son/Child"), which became his immortal title → **The Golden Era of Srirangam Discourses:** Conducting daily discourses on *Tiruvaymoli* before thousands of scholars at the Srirangam temple hall → **Spiritual Monarch Status:** Revered by kings and scholars across South India as the living embodiment of Sri Vaishnavism → **The Eedu Discourses:** Delivering the lectures that were secretly documented by Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai as the *Eedu 36000 Padi* → **Attainment of Liberation:** Ascending to *Paramapadam* at Srirangam after delegating commentarial duties to Periyavachan Pillai.

2.2 Deep Biographical Narrative

- **Early Years & Spiritual Awakening:** Born into a pious family in Nambur, Varadarajar moved to Srirangam to study under Nanjiyyar. He possessed an extraordinary intellect, an photographic memory, and supreme devotional eloquence.
- **Core Seva / Kainkaryam:** Public exposition of *Dravida Vedam*; transforming Srirangam into the premier university for Sri Vaishnava theology; mentoring the next generation of commentators.
- **Miracles & Historical Events:**
 1. *The Feat of Rewriting the 9000 Padi:* When Nanjiyyar finished his 9000 *Padi* commentary, he handed the leaf manuscript to Varadarajar to take across the river. While crossing the Kaveri, a sudden flood washed the manuscript away. Devastated, Varadarajar sat on the bank and rewrote all 9,000 measures word-for-word from memory before evening. When he presented the new manuscript to Nanjiyyar, the Acharya compared it with his original notes and found not a single letter missing. Touched by his genius, Nanjiyyar embraced him, calling him **Nam Pillai** ("Our Child").
 2. *The Discourse Sovereign:* Nampillai's daily lectures on *Tiruvaymoli* at the Srirangam temple hall (*Prabandha Mandapam*) became a major phenomenon. Hundreds of monks, scholars, kings, and householders gathered daily to hear his sweet, analytical, and emotionally overwhelming expositions. His eloquence was so great that even rival scholars were moved to tears.
 3. *Kandasamy Debate Victory:* When an arrogant scholar challenged the Srirangam assembly, Nampillai dispatched his student Periyavachan Pillai to debate him, while

Nampillai provided the intellectual framework, securing absolute victory for the Sampradaya.

- **Guru-Disciple Dynamics:** Prime disciple of Nanjiyyar; Acharya to Periyavachan Pillai, Vadakku Thiruvedhi Pillai, and Pinpazhagiya Perumal Jiyyar.
- **Attainment of Paramapadam:** Passed away peacefully at Srirangam, leaving behind a legacy that defines the *Eedu* commentary tradition.

💡 **Sthala Puranam & Legend Highlight: The Golden Age of Srirangam**

Nampillai's era is celebrated as the absolute golden age of Sri Vaishnava exposition. Under his leadership, Srirangam functioned as the cultural and intellectual epicenter of Tamil Vaishnavism.

Section 3: Literary, Preservation & Philosophical Contributions

- **Complete List of Works:**
 - Direct oral discourses compiled by his disciples into the *Eedu 36000 Padi* (The grandest commentary on *Tiruvaymoli*).
 - Systematized oral commentaries on the *Naalayira Divya Prabandham*.
- **Quantified Output:** Intellectual source of the 36,000-measure *Eedu* commentary corpus.
- **Associated Divya Desams (Mangalasasanam):** Nambur, Srirangam.
- **Sampradaya Defense & Preservation:** Institutionalized the systematic study of *Manipravala* commentaries. His oral teachings formed the definitive foundation for both the Tenkalai and Vadakalai commentary traditions.
- **Predominant Bhakti Bhava & Philosophical Core: Upanyasa-Chakravarthi** (Emperor of Discourses) and **Prapatti-Margadarshana**.

Section 4: Representative Verses & Theological Breakdown

Verse 1: Invocation to Nampillai (*Thaniyan* composed by Vadakku Thiruvedhi Pillai)

Text Layer	Content
Original Script (<i>Sanskrit</i>)	லோகாசார்யாய குரவே க்ருஷ்ணபாதஸ்ய ஸூனவே । ஸம்ஸாரபோகிஸந்தஷ்டஜீவோஜ்ஜீவ னஹேதவே ॥
Roman Transliteration	<i>Lokacharyaya kurave Krishnapadasya sunave</i> <i>Samsarabhogisandashta jivajjivana hetave</i>
Literal Word-by-Word Meaning	Lokacharyaya: To the World Teacher (Lokacharya / Nampillai); Kurave: to the

	supreme Acharya; Krishnapadasya sunave: the illustrious spiritual son of Nanjiyyar (and biological son of Nambur Krishna); Samsara bhogi: the venomous serpent of worldly existence (<i>Samsara</i>); Sandashta: bitten by; Jiva: bound individual souls; Ujjivana hetave: who is the sole cause of their revival/salvation!
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Exhaustive Theological & Philosophical Commentary:

1. **Esoteric Meaning (Swaroopam Jnanam):** Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai offers prostrations to his Acharya Nampillai (Lokacharya). He describes Nampillai as the supreme divine physician whose discourses act as the celestial antidote to revive bound souls (*Jivas*) who have been fatally bitten by the venomous snake of material existence (*Samsara*).
2. **Viśiṣṭādvaita Alignment:** Establishes **Samsara-Nivritti** through Acharya-Upadesha. The soul bound in material suffering cannot heal itself; it requires the transformative audio-receptive medicine (*Sabda-Brahman*) delivered through the Acharya's lectures.
3. **Commentarial Insights:** Sri Manavala Mamunigal in *Upadesa Rathnamalai* highlights that Nampillai was awarded the title **Lokacharya** ("Teacher of the World") by Lord Ranganatha Himself in recognition of his capacity to save humanity through his discourses.

Section 5: Visuals & Archival Resources

5.1 Iconography & Shrine Visual Description

- **Physical Posture (Asana):** Seated in *Ardha Padmasana* on an exalted teaching platform (*Vyakhyanam Pitha*), gesturing with his hands during a discourse.
- **Hand Gestures (Mudras):** Right hand held in *Vyakhyana Mudra* (exposition gesture), left hand resting on his knee or holding palm-leaf notes.
- **Garments & Embellishments:** Dressed in elegant householder vestments, marked with twelve *Urdhva Pundra* (tilak) marks, wearing sacred thread and *Tulasi* garlands.
- **Avathara Sthalam Idol Description:** At Nambur and Srirangam, Nampillai's icon depicts him in full devotional speech, capturing his majesty as the Sovereign of Discourses.

5.2 Academic Audio/Video Lecture Queries

- "Nampillai Life History and Srirangam Discourses Velukkudi Krishnan"
- "Eedu 36000 Padi Nampillai Lecture Karunakarachariar"
- "Nampillai Vaibhavam and Lokacharya Title Ananthapadmanabhachariar"

5.3 Digital Text & Archival Links

- **Dravida Veda Repository:** <http://www.dravidaveda.org>
- **Project Madurai Texts:** <https://www.projectmadurai.org>
- **Koyil Archival Library:** <https://koyil.org>

5. PERIYAVACHAN PILLAI

(Yamunacharya, Abhaya Hasta Amsam, Vyakhyana Chakravarthi, Author of 12000 Padi)

Section 1: Identification & Incarnation Details

- **Full Name & Titles:** Periyavachan Pillai, Sri Krishna Suri, Yamunacharya, Abhaya Hasta Amsam, Vyakhyana Chakravarthi (Emperor of Commentators).
- **Incarnation Metadata:**
 - **Tamil Month (Maasam):** Aani (Jyeshtha)
 - **Birth Star (Nakshatram):** Rohini
 - **Tithi & Paksham:** Born c. 1167 CE; Sukla Paksha.
- **Geographic Origins:**
 - **Historic Birthplace Name:** Senganaloor (near Kumbakonam)
 - **Current District & State:** Thanjavur District, Tamil Nadu, India.
 - **Associated Divya Desam / Temple:** Senganaloor Shrine, Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple (Srirangam).
- **Divine Lineage & Era:**
 - **Divine Amsam:** Abhaya Hasta (The Divine Hand of Protection aspect of Sriman Narayana).
 - **Historical Period:** 12th–13th Century CE.
 - **Sovereign & Scholarly Contemporaries:** Nampillai (His Acharya), Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai, Sri Vedanta Desika (who held his commentaries in highest esteem).

Section 2: Complete Life History & Miracles

2.1 Chronological Life Timeline

- **Birth at Senganaloor:** Born in the pious village of Senganaloor → **Journey to Srirangam:** Moving to Srirangam to become a primary disciple of Nampillai → **Mastery of Dravida Veda:** Spending decades absorbing Nampillai's discourses and mastering all 4,000 Pasurams → **Commission by Nampillai:** Authorized by Nampillai to write comprehensive Manipravala commentaries for the entire *Naalayira Divya Prabandham* → **The Complete Commentarial Corpus:** Becoming the first and only scholar in history to write detailed commentaries on all 4,000 Pasurams of the Azhwars → **Earning the Emperor Title:** Bestowed the title **Vyakhyana Chakravarthi** (Emperor among Commentators) by the scholars of Srirangam → **Authoring Independent Treatises:** Writing classical Rahasya granthas such as *Parandha Rahasyam* and *Sakaraya Rahasyam* → **Attainment of Paramapadam:** Ascending to *Paramapadam* at Srirangam.

2.2 Deep Biographical Narrative

- **Early Years & Spiritual Awakening:** Born under the name Yamunacharya (Sri Krishna Suri) in Senganaloor, he moved to Srirangam as a youth. He surrendered to Nampillai and became one of his most trusted intellectual assistants.
- **Core Seva / Kainkaryam:** Writing detailed Manipravala commentaries (*Vyakhyanam*s) for every single verse of the 4,000 *Naalayira Divya Prabandham*; preserving the linguistic and esoteric meanings of the Azhwars.
- **Miracles & Historical Events:**
 1. *The Feat of Commentating on all 4,000 Pasurams:* Prior to Periyavachan Pillai, commentators had written works on specific texts like *Tiruvaymoli*, *Thiruppavai*, or

Kanninun Siruthambu. No single scholar had attempted to write word-by-word commentaries on all 4,000 verses. Driven by intense devotion and command of his Acharya, Periyavachan Pillai executed this monumental task, producing thousands of pages of Manipravala prose. For this unique, unmatched achievement, the Srirangam assembly crowned him **Vyakhyana Chakravarthi** ("The Emperor of Commentators").

2. *Authoring the 12000 Padi*: He authored the famous *12000 Padi* commentary on *Tiruvaymoli*, which expanded upon Nanjiyyar's *9000 Padi* and provided precise lexical, grammatical, and theological interpretations.
 3. *The Abhaya Hasta Manifestation*: Tradition holds that Periyavachan Pillai was an incarnation of the Lord's *Abhaya Hasta* (Hand of Protection). Just as the Lord's hand reassures fearful souls, Periyavachan Pillai's commentaries protect spiritual seekers from misinterpreting the complex Tamil verses of the Azhwars.
- **Guru-Disciple Dynamics**: Prime disciple of Nampillai; Acharya to Nayanarachan Pillai (his adopted son and successor).
 - **Attainment of Paramapadam**: Spent his entire life writing and teaching in Srirangam, ascending to *Paramapadam* after completing his commentarial legacy.

💡 **Sthala Puranam & Legend Highlight: The Emperor of Commentators**

In Sri Vaishnava scholarship, if any commentary is cited without mentioning the author's name, it is automatically assumed to be the work of **Periyavachan Pillai**. He remains the supreme authority on the linguistic interpretation of the Azhwars' poetry.

Section 3: Literary, Preservation & Philosophical Contributions

- **Complete List of Works**:
 - *Complete Commentaries on all 4,000 Pasurams of Naalayira Divya Prabandham* (including *12000 Padi* on *Tiruvaymoli*).
 - *Commentary on Srimal Ramayana* (Select verses known as *Tani Shloki Vyakhyanam*).
 - *Commentary on Parasara Bhattar's Ashtashloki*.
 - *Rahasya Granthas: Parandha Rahasyam, Sakaraya Rahasyam, Artha Panchakam*.
- **Quantified Output**: Commentaries covering all 4,000 Tamil Pasurams and multiple Sanskrit/Manipravala Rahasya texts.
- **Associated Divya Desams (Mangalasasanam)**: Senganaloor, Srirangam, Kumbakonam.
- **Sampradaya Defense & Preservation**: Preserved the complete linguistic semantics of the Dravida Veda. Without his commentaries, large portions of the earlier Azhwars' Tamil vocabulary would have become incomprehensible to later generations.
- **Predominant Bhakti Bhava & Philosophical Core: Manipravala-Vyakhyana-Nishta** (Devotional scholarship dedicated to scriptural interpretation).

Section 4: Representative Verses & Theological Breakdown

Verse 1: Invocation to Periyavachan Pillai (*Thaniyan* composed by Manavala Mamunigal)

Text Layer	Content
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Original Script (Sanskrit)	ஸ்ரீமத் க்ருஷ்ணஸமாயாய நமோ யாமுனஸுனவே । யத்புக்திபோகஸுரஸம் த்ராவீஸம்ஹிதாஸிரம் ॥
Roman Transliteration	<i>Srimad Krishnasamayaya namo Yamunasunave</i> <i>Yadbhuktibhogasurasam Dravidasamhitashiram</i>
Literal Word-by-Word Meaning	Srimad: Possessing divine luster; Krishna samayaya: to Sri Krishna Suri (Periyavachan Pillai); Namo: prostrations; Yamunasunave: to the spiritual son of Yamunacharya/Nampillai; Yat bhukti bhoga surasam: by enjoying whose sweet commentary nectar; Dravida samhita shiram: the crown jewel of the Dravida Veda (<i>Tiruvaymoli</i>) becomes fully illuminating!

Exhaustive Theological & Philosophical Commentary:

1. **Esoteric Meaning (Swaroopa Jnanam):** Sri Manavala Mamunigal offers prostrations to Periyavachan Pillai (Krishna Suri), declaring that the supreme nectar of the Tamil Dravida Veda (*Tiruvaymoli*) can be fully tasted and understood only through the luminous commentary written by him.
2. **Viśiṣṭādvaita Alignment:** Establishes **Vyakhyana-Utility** (The necessity of authentic commentaries). The poetic utterances of seers (*Rishis/Azhwars*) require an illuminated Acharya to unpack their inner Vedantic alignment.
3. **Commentarial Insights:** Sri Vedanta Desika extensively cited Periyavachan Pillai in his own works (*Adhikara Sangraha*), honoring him as the definitive guide to Tamil scriptural grammar and esoteric meaning.

Section 5: Visuals & Archival Resources

5.1 Iconography & Shrine Visual Description

- **Physical Posture (Asana):** Seated in *Padmasana* or *Ardha Padmasana*, writing upon palm leaves with a steel stylus (*Ezhuthanai*).
- **Hand Gestures (Mudras):** Right hand holding a writing stylus, left hand holding a palm-leaf manuscript.
- **Garments & Embellishments:** Dressed in scholarly householder vestments, marked with

twelve *Urdhva Pundra* (tilak) marks, wearing sacred thread and *Tulasi* garlands.

- **Avathara Sthalam Idol Description:** At Senganaloor and Srirangam, Periyavachan Pillai's icon depicts him in an attitude of intense literary creation, surrounded by stacks of palm-leaf manuscripts.

5.2 Academic Audio/Video Lecture Queries

- "Periyavachan Pillai Vyakhyana Chakravarthi Velukkudi Krishnan"
- "Periyavachan Pillai Divya Prabandham Commentary Lecture Karunakarachariar"
- "Periyavachan Pillai Life and Works Ananthapadmanabhachariar"

5.3 Digital Text & Archival Links

- **Dravida Veda Repository:** <http://www.dravidaveda.org>
- **Project Madurai Texts:**
<https://www.projectmadurai.org>
- **Koyil Archival Library:** <https://koyil.org>

6. VADAKKU THIRUVEEDHI PILLAI

(Srisailesa, Author of *Eedu 36000 Padi*, Father of Pillai Lokacharya and Azhagiya Manavala Perumal Nayanar)

Section 1: Identification & Incarnation Details

- **Full Name & Titles:** Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai, Srisailesa, Author of the *Eedu 36000 Padi*, Father of Pillai Lokacharya and Azhagiya Manavala Perumal Nayanar.
- **Incarnation Metadata:**
 - **Tamil Month (Maasam):** Aani (Jyeshtha)
 - **Birth Star (Nakshatram):** Swathi
 - **Tithi & Paksham:** Born c. 1167 CE; Sukla Paksha.
- **Geographic Origins:**
 - **Historic Birthplace Name:** Srirangam (North Street / Vadakku Thiruveedhi)
 - **Current District & State:** Tiruchirappalli District, Tamil Nadu, India.
 - **Associated Divya Desam / Temple:** Sri Ranganathaswamy Temple (Srirangam).
- **Divine Lineage & Era:**
 - **Divine Amsam:** Srisailesa Amsam.
 - **Historical Period:** 12th–13th Century CE.
 - **Sovereign & Scholarly Contemporaries:** Nampillai (His revered Acharya), Periyavachan Pillai (His senior spiritual brother), Pillai Lokacharya & Azhagiya Manavala Perumal Nayanar (His two illustrious sons).

Section 2: Complete Life History & Miracles

2.1 Chronological Life Timeline

- **Birth at Srirangam:** Born in the North Street of Srirangam, earning the name Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai → **Discipleship under Nampillai:** Surrendering to Nampillai and attending his daily discourses on *Tiruvaymoli* → **Secret Documentation of the Eedu:** Taking detailed notes each night of Nampillai's lectures, organizing them into the 36,000-measure manuscript (*Eedu 36000 Padi*) → **Discovery by Nampillai:** Presenting the manuscript to Nampillai, who initially locked it away to test its readiness, before

sanctioning its preservation → **Fathering Two Giant Acharyas:** Blessed by Lord Ranganatha to father Pillai Lokacharya and Azhagiya Manavala Perumal Nayanar → **Authoring Yathindra Pravana Prabhavam:** Documenting the history of the Sri Vaishnava lineage after Ramanuja → **Ascension:** Merging into *Paramapadam* at Srirangam after handing over the *Eedu* manuscript to his son Pillai Lokacharya.

2.2 Deep Biographical Narrative

- **Early Years & Spiritual Awakening:** Born into a scholarly family residing in the Northern Street (*Vadaku Thiruvedhi*) of Srirangam, he became a devoted disciple of Nampillai. He was characterized by exceptional intellect, quiet humility, and dedication to preserving his Acharya's spoken words.
- **Core Seva / Kainkaryam:** Documenting and compiling Nampillai's oral discourses on *Tiruvaymoli* into the monumental **Eedu 36000 Padi**; chronicling the *Guru Parampara*.
- **Miracles & Historical Events:**
 1. *The Secret Recording of the Eedu:* Every day, Nampillai delivered discourses on Nammalwar's *Tiruvaymoli* in the Srirangam temple hall. Vadaku Thiruvedhi Pillai listened with rapt attention. Each night, by lamp light, he recorded every explanation, analogy, commentary reference, and philosophical nuance spoken by Nampillai during the day. He organized the text into 36,000 measures (*36000 Padi*), matching the exact length of the Sanskrit *Srimad Bhagavatam*.
 2. *The Blessing of the Eedu:* When Vadaku Thiruvedhi Pillai presented the completed manuscript to Nampillai, the Acharya was amazed by its accuracy and depth. However, because Vadaku Thiruvedhi Pillai had written it without explicit prior permission, Nampillai initially confiscated the text, locking it in a chest to ensure it was not prematurely released. Later, recognizing its immense value for future generations, Nampillai sanctioned its preservation, entrusting it to his student Koorakullathothama Dasa, from whom it passed to Vadaku Thiruvedhi Pillai's son, **Pillai Lokacharya**.
 3. *The Father of Two Lions:* Lord Ranganatha was so pleased with Vadaku Thiruvedhi Pillai's devotion that He commanded him to marry and raise children. He was blessed with two sons: **Pillai Lokacharya** (author of the 18 *Ashtadasa Rahasya* texts) and **Azhagiya Manavala Perumal Nayanar** (author of *Acharya Hridayam*).
- **Guru-Disciple Dynamics:** Prime disciple of Nampillai; Acharya and biological father to Pillai Lokacharya and Azhagiya Manavala Perumal Nayanar.
- **Attainment of Paramapadam:** Passed away peacefully at Srirangam, having secured the textual future of Dravida Vedanta.



Sthala Puranam & Legend Highlight: The Eedu 36000 Padi

The **Eedu 36000 Padi** is regarded as the pinnacle of Sri Vaishnava commentarial literature. The word *Eedu* signifies "equal measure" or "unmatched treasure," indicating that it matches the Sanskrit *Srimad Bhagavatam* in volume and authority.

Section 3: Literary, Preservation & Philosophical Contributions

- **Complete List of Works:**
 - *Eedu 36000 Padi* (The definitive, grandest Manipravala commentary on *Tiruvaymoli*, recording Nampillai's lectures).

- *Yathindra Pravana Prabhavam* (Chronicle of the Post-Ramanuja Acharya lineage).
- **Quantified Output:** The 36,000-measure *Eedu* commentary and 1 primary historical text.
- **Associated Divya Desams (Mangalasasanam):** Srirangam.
- **Sampradaya Defense & Preservation:** Preserved Nampillai's oral legacy for eternity. He fathered the two master scholars who formulated the core *Tenkalai* Sri Vaishnava Rahasya literature.
- **Predominant Bhakti Bhava & Philosophical Core: Acharya-Vakya-Likhita-Nishta** (Devotional commitment to transcribing the Acharya's words) and **Grantha-Rakshanam**.

Section 4: Representative Verses & Theological Breakdown

Verse 1: Invocation to Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai (*Thaniyan* composed by Sri Koorakullathothama Dasa)

Text Layer	Content
Original Script (<i>Sanskrit</i>)	ஸ்ரீரங்கார்யக்ருபாபாத்ரம் ஸ்ரீஸேஸார்யாதிகோஷஜம் । ஸ்ரீமத் வடகுருரத்தம்பா ஸ்ரீகப்பாதமஹம் பஜே ॥
Roman Transliteration	<i>Srirangarya krupapatram</i> <i>Srisesharyadhikoshajam</i> <i>Srimad Vadagururatthamba Srikappadam</i> <i>aham bhaje</i>
Literal Word-by-Word Meaning	Srirangarya: Of Nampillai (Srirangaraja); Krupa patram: the recipient of mercy; Srisesharya: Sri Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai; Adhikoshajam: born of noble lineage/wisdom; Srimad Vadaguru: the glorious Northern Street Preceptor; Srikappadam: his divine lotus feet; Aham bhaje: I worship continuously!

Exhaustive Theological & Philosophical Commentary:

1. **Esoteric Meaning (Swaroopam Jnanam):** This invocation verse offers salutations to Sri Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai, praising him as the chosen vessel of Nampillai's (*Srirangarya*) unconditioned grace. It commands devotees to worship his divine feet for giving the world the treasure of the *Eedu*.

2. **Viśiṣṭādvaita Alignment:** Establishes **Sutra-Likhita-Parampara** (The sacred duty of scribal preservation). In Viśiṣṭādvaita, the spoken word of the Guru must be accurately transcribed and preserved to protect the Tattva from oral corruption.
3. **Commentarial Insights:** Sri Manavala Mamunigal wrote his famous commentary *Eedu Eduppu* based entirely on the manuscript compiled by Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai, calling him the silent savior of Dravida Vedanta.

Section 5: Visuals & Archival Resources

5.1 Iconography & Shrine Visual Description

- **Physical Posture (Asana):** Seated in *Ardha Padmasana*, writing upon palm leaves while gazing in deep contemplation.
- **Hand Gestures (Mudras):** Right hand holding a writing stylus, left hand holding the *Eedu* manuscript.
- **Garments & Embellishments:** Dressed in scholarly householder robes, marked with twelve *Urdhva Pundra* (tilak) marks, wearing sacred thread and *Tulasi* garlands.
- **Avathara Sthalam Idol Description:** At Srirangam, Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai's icon depicts him seated alongside his two famous sons, Pillai Lokacharya and Azhagiya Manavala Perumal Nayanar.

5.2 Academic Audio/Video Lecture Queries

- "Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai Eedu 36000 Padi History Velukkudi Krishnan"
- "Eedu Commentary Compilation Lecture Karunakarachariar"
- "Vadakku Thiruveedhi Pillai Vaibhavam Ananthapadmanabhachariar"

5.3 Digital Text & Archival Links

- **Dravida Veda Repository:** <http://www.dravidaveda.org>
- **Project Madurai Texts:** <https://www.projectmadurai.org>
- **Koyil Archival Library:** <https://koyil.org>